

MOBILE COMPUTING & TELEWORKING POLICY

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Policy is to protect information of Acronotics, while using mobile computing facilities.

A process is in place to manage the activities of Acronotics when employees are working from home and/or from public areas. Every employee performing work for, or on behalf of, Acronotics must be diligent in his or her efforts to protect the Acronotics information assets, especially when telecommuting or working from a remote location.

2. Scope

This policy applies equally to all employees utilizing portable computing devices / mobile computing devices and access Acronotics Information processing facility.

Terms & Definitions

Abbreviation / Term	Full Form / Description
Individual Users / Employees	Employees / Users in Acronotics's premises
Information processing facility	Any information processing system, service or infrastructure, or the physical locations housing them

1. Policy

1.1 Basic Security of Mobile Computing Device

- Passwords chosen should be difficult to guess or hack but can be remembered without having to write them down.
- All the relevant patches should be updated in the mobile computing devices' operating system. This will help in avoiding most of the security vulnerabilities.
- The data on the mobile computing device is more expensive to replace than the hardware. Hence all the data should always be backed up before proceeding on an extended trip.
- All laptops must be configured with a password protected screen saver that activates after no more than 15 minutes idle time.
- In situations where the mobile computing device is used from home, all items (CD, disks, paper, mobile computing device) containing Acronotics information should be guarded. If they are to be discarded, then they should be destroyed completely and the same should be informed Acronotics office also.

- Mobile computing devices provided by Acronotics should be used only for official purposes by the employee. Usage of the device by friends and family people should be discouraged. Care should be taken not to expose the information inside the device to family or friends.
- Notwithstanding the above, such usage should be construed as “inappropriate usage” and departmental action may be initiated.

1.2 Physical Security of Mobile Computing Device

- All laptops acquired for or on behalf of Acronotics will always remain Acronotics property. Each employee provided with a laptop is responsible for the security of that laptop, regardless of whether the laptop is used in the office, at his/her residence, or in any other location such as a hotel, conference room, car, or airport.
- Laptop computers must **NOT** be:
 - Left on view in an unattended vehicle, even for a short period of time,
 - Left in a vehicle overnight,
 - Positioned so that they are visible from outside a ground floor window unless there is no alternative.
- A laptop displaying sensitive information being used in a public place, e.g., on a train, aircraft, or bus, must whenever possible be positioned so that the screen cannot be viewed by others.
- In vulnerable situations, e.g., public areas such as airport lounges, hotels, and conference centers, the laptop must never be left unattended.
- Laptops should whenever permitted be carried as hand luggage when travelling.
- Where any of the above rules are either inappropriate or impractical the owner is responsible for taking all reasonable steps to minimize the risk of loss or damage of the laptop.
- Once the mobile computing user leaves the corporate buildings and connects to the web from home or a hotel room, their data is vulnerable to attack.

1.3 Protection against Virus

- Anti-virus software must be included in the software suite and configured to scan files as they are installed or copied to the laptop; this functionality should not be disabled due to the prevalence of computer worms and viruses or by any other means.
- Loading or installing non-business-related items onto the laptop should be discouraged.
- Any virus infection on the mobile computing device should immediately be informed to the IT Helpdesk and should be disconnected, if it is connected to the network of Acronotics if possible, the mobile computing device may be switched off.

- Executable software must, whenever possible, be validated and approved by Management (IT) before being installed onto the laptop. Unauthorized installations can compromise the IT operating environment and constitute a security risk, including the intentional or unintentional spreading of software viruses and other malicious software.
- Devices which are taken out of corporate network should always be scanned for malicious codes before being connected to the LAN. The temporary internet files and cookies should be deleted as a safety precaution.
- Any device brought into the LAN environment of Acronotics including that of visitors who desire to connect to the LAN, should always be scanned using the official anti-virus scanner s/w before being allowed to connect.

1.4 Protection of Data

- The laptop must be formatted with NTFS file system.
- All sensitive information must be updated / stored on SharePoint by the user. This ensures that such data is secure and is automatically backed up as per the backup policy.
- Only when working away from "base" should sensitive data be copied to a local drive on the laptop. In all cases, only the minimum information required should be copied to the local drive.
- All changes made whilst disconnected must be copied/synced to your SharePoint once reconnected to the network.

1.5 VPN Access

- All external connections from employees, contractors, and consultants to Acronotics intranet should be via VPN.
- The VPN client software should be licensed and original. It should have the approval of Acronotics.
- Any temporary VPN access should be authorized by Management (IT) / CISO and the same should be revoked on completion of the relevant task.
- The VPN connections must always be authenticated. Detected violations or failure of authentication must be logged as a security event and a security alarm must be raised and investigated.
- Users should not have the facility to browse the internet or use Acronotics intranet as a pass-through to sites on the internet. The access will be available only to the intranet of Acronotics.

- Sensitive and confidential information shall be transferred over the internet using a secure connection only i.e., using encryption.
- VPN connectivity shall be established between Acronotics networks for transfer of information/data. Data transfer over a VPN tunnel using IPsec with AES, SHA-2 and pre-shared key.
- This is to ensure the privacy and integrity of the sensitive data passing over the public network. Appropriate means for distributing and maintaining encryption keys must be established prior to operational use of VPNs.
- VPN connection logs shall be monitored, maintained, and reviewed.
- VPN access should always be used only for business purposes. There should be no deviation whatsoever from this rule.
- VPN access should be used only by the employee who has the authorization. At no point in time, the username/password be passed on or shared with anybody.
- If any personal equipment/devices are used for connecting to the Acronotics network from remote, they should have prior approval from CISO in writing. These systems should always meet the Acronotics specifications.

1.6 Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee / User	Requesting for mobile computing device, physical security, protection of data, basic security, and surrender of mobile computing device.
Management	Approval of request
IT Manager	VPN/SharePoint access, protection against virus, protection of data
Management (IT)	Approval & providing the device

1.7 Issuing a Mobile Computing Device

Whenever an employee is to be provided with a mobile computing device, he/she will raise the request for the same to the IT Department.

Authorization from Management

Respective Management will have to approve the user's request based on business requirements.

After approving the user's request by Management for mobile computing device, it would be forwarded to Management (IT) for his approval. Management (IT) will approve the request based on the availability of devices.

Assigning the Mobile Computing Device

Once Management approves the request for mobile computing device, IT Manager will issue the device to the employee / user. All details specific to the device and user will be captured.

1.8 Surrender of Mobile Computing Device

Employee / user should surrender the mobile computing device to IT Manager / IT department before leaving the organization or at the end of the assigned period of time. The IT Manager should remove the user's permission, data, software, etc., and update the list of available mobile computing devices in stock.

1.9 Mobile Computing Device Usages

Employee/user should use the mobile computing device as per **Asset Acceptable Usage Policy** of Acronotics. Employee/user should take care of the following things during the period of having mobile computing devices in his / her possession.

Physical Security

Employees / Users should be responsible for physical security of mobile computing devices. He / She should follow the guideline provided by Acronotics for physical security of device.

Protection against Malware

Employee / User are responsible for protection of mobile computing devices / laptops against virus or malicious code. The IT department should configure and update antivirus software before handing over the device to the employee/user.

If a laptop / mobile device is out of the office for more than 15 calendar days, it should be given to the IT department for scanning against viruses or malicious code before connecting to the Acronotics office network.

Protection of Data

Employee / User are responsible for the data stored in mobile computing device / laptop. He / She should store business related data at centralized file server of Acronotics.

VPN Access

Management (IT) is responsible for providing VPN access to employees / users based on the approval of user's request from the respective Management. Network administrator should monitor the VPN connection to Acronotics network.

1.10 Tele-working

Individual requests for home working/tele-working will be reviewed on their own merits in accordance with existing HR procedures. Agreement to a specific request will depend on an objective assessment of whether the employee's work can be done from home without any detriment to Acronotics services. The assessment will include the following (but not limited to):

- The nature of the work to be performed at the tele-working place is operationally feasible.
- The overall quality and quantity of work carried out in the designated workplace shall be sustained by the employee in the tele-working place.
- The work done at the tele-working place should be cost-effective. Certain up-front costs are permissible, provided they can be recouped over a reasonable period.
- The terms and conditions of employment, provisions of relevant collective agreements and the application of existing policies and legislation will continue to apply in tele-working situations.

The details of the tele-working arrangement must be discussed and agreed upon between the employee participating in the tele-working situation and the supervisor and at the request of either party these details will be put in writing:

- The duration of the arrangement
 - The specific days the employee will tele-work, hours of work
 - Whether the arrangement will be regular or episodic
 - The tele-work location
 - Work objectives and expected results
 - The requirement to adhere to all aspects of government policies, rules, and regulations.
- Only authorized employees are allowed to access Acronotics information when used at home in any form, on any media. Unauthorized individuals, including family members, must not be allowed to access Acronotics data or assets. Use of any information at home must be for work purposes only.
 - Employees must ensure the security of information within their home from theft.
 - Users shall use only company designated laptops for tele-working.
 - Connection to Acronotics assets to home broadband networks for internet access is permitted but users should use a cabled connection where possible and only use wireless on condition that security is enabled to at least Acronotics authentication.
 - Sensitive information must be locked away when not in use and only be accessible by the employee.

2. References/Forms/Templates

- [Backup Policy](#)
- [Asset Acceptable Usage Policy](#)
- [Laptop Responsibility agreement/Asset Issuance Form](#)